A3 PROBLEM SOLVING

Focus: Reduce waiting, searching and rework

GOAL / TARGET
92 min → ≤ 65 min lead time

1. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Customer requests take excessive time to resolve due to long waiting periods, fragmented information across systems, multiple handoffs and rework.
Impact: poorer customer experience and lower operational efficiency.

2. CURRENT CONDITION

- Lead time: 92 min
- Processing time: 28 min (30%)
- Waiting time: 64 min (70%)
- Multiple system searches, handoffs and follow-up

3. TARGET CONDITION

- Lead time ≤ 65 min
- Waiting time reduced by ≥ 40%
- Fewer handoffs and rework
- Real-time request-status visibility
- Seamless information flow

4. ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS — 5 WHYS

WHY 1 Why do customers wait?
→ Requests enters queues / customers cannot see status directly.

WHY 2 Why is status not visible in real time?
→ Information is stored in multiple systems.

WHY 3 Why multiple systems?
→ No unified tracking across systems.

WHY 4 Why no unified tracking?
→ Process ownership is fragmented.

WHY 5 ROOT CAUSE
→ Lack of an integrated status view and clear process ownership.

5. COUNTERMEASURES

1. Create unified status view for real-time visibility

2. Define clear process ownership and handoff rules

3. Standardize customer information intake to reduce rework

4. Enable proactive status updates

5. Integrate relevant status data across systems.

6. SUCCESS MEASURES

Lead Time
≤ 65 min

Waiting Time
reduced by ≥ 40%

Rework / Follow-up
- Reduced

Customer Experience
- Fewer repeat contacts

Process Efficiency
- Reduced handoffs & searches

KEY TAKEAWAY

The core issue is fragmented information and unclear process ownership, creating waiting, rework and longer lead time. The countermeasures directly address those root causes.